

## Awash with camera

With more than 4 million CCTV cameras operating around the country, UK has more video surveillance than anywhere else in the world

## Recognise the culprit

In USA the government is currently funding research into technologies that will allow a camera to identify a person at up to 500 ft by their facial features

Smart SoHo

# STAY SAFE with electronic security systems

Anoop Verma

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

Reports of burglaries have become so common in the media that they have started sounding clichéd to the denizens of our urban concrete jungle. Quite often burglaries entail not just loss of material wealth, but also the very tragic loss of lives. Then there is the threat posed by fire. Most of the buildings are typically encumbered with myriad elements that can easily serve as a catalyst for a fire to break out. While many of us follow the method of security known as “let’s pray to God that nothing bad will happen to our home or office,” a multitude of electronic security solutions are available to protect our precious belongings from falling prey to fire or burglary. When Robin Sinha bought his house in New Delhi, he wanted to have an extra layer of safety to protect his wife and one year old kid, during the hours that he would be away working in his office.

“The crime rate in my city continues to go up on a day-to-day basis, and I didn’t want to take any chances,” he says, “so I decided to go in for Electronic Security, which comprises CCTV system at the main door, and an alarm system.” Today, there is simply no dearth of excellent security systems that incorporate hi-tech wizardry of next-gen electronics. With many companies in the fray, for making and marketing such systems, there is enough competition to keep prices at a reasonable level. Electronic security systems are available to suit all kinds of needs and budgets. Robin Sinha is a middle class IT professional, but the amount that he spent in installing the security system in his house has, in his own reasoning, turned out to be worth

the peace of mind and the new sense of security that he and his family can now bask in.

Two Indian companies, Zicom and Micro Technologies, have garnered a lot of buzz when it comes to electronic security devices. They are into providing tools for home and office security and prevention of vehicle theft. You can buy their systems online or from myriad retail outlets across the country. Some of the equipment that these companies manufacture certainly seems conducive to raising the confidence levels of residents. For instance, with Zicom Safehomes, the company is offering an “i-alert 24/7 service.” This is an emergency response system that is active 24x7, 365 days. If any emergency situation is detected in your house, the system immediately sends a signal to the i-alert 24x7 service for appropriate action. Similarly, Micro

Technologies, in its home security system, is offering an emergency SMS service, through which you can receive alerts.

A congested modern urban environment can easily turn into the breeding ground for myriad threats and so it makes sense for the residents and office owners to take assistance of electronic security measures.

## Keeping the home safe

Imagine the plight of a family that in the thick of night is sleeping

soundly at home, when out of nowhere a gang of burglars turn up. Soon the family is tied up, and the burglars have a free run of the house. In order to avoid such an

